Qingqing Yang

PhD student in Experimental Psychology | The Ohio State University
Yang.6118@osu.edu | qingqing-yang-177.github.io

Research Interests

Visual attention, memory, and decision-making.
Neural mechanisms of the goal-directed behaviors in human visual system.
Integrate behavioral measurements (psychophysics, eye-tracking) and neuroimaging (fMRI, TMS).

Education

The Ohio State University, OSU — 2024 – Present
Ph.D. in Experimental Psychology, Cognitive Neuroscience Program — Ohio, USA
Advisors: Hsin-Hung Li, Julie Golomb

New York University, NYU — 2021 – 2023
M.A. in Psychology, 3.97/4 — New York, USA
Advisor: Clayton Curtis
Research Focus: How human parietal cortex contributes to the quality of working memory.

Zhejiang University, ZJU — 2017 – 2021
B.Sc. in Psychology, 3.92/4 — Zhejiang, China
Advisor: Hui Chen
Research Focus: The mechanism of attention guided by working memory contents.

Research Experience

Assistant Research Scientist, NYU — 08/2023 – 04/2024
Advisor: Clayton Curtis
Conducted behavioral (eye-tracking) experiments on prioritization effect in working memory, while temporarily perturbed parietal cortex activity (TMS).

Assistant Research Scientist, NYU — 09/2023 – 04/2024
Advisors: Catherine Hartley, Noam Goldway
Applied reinforcement learning models to quantify decision-making properties. Analyzed fMRI data to relate these properties to brain activities and clinical symptoms across development.

Publications

* denotes equal contributions.

Yang Q, Li HH (2025). Efficient Allocation of Working Memory Resource for Utility Maximization in Humans and Recurrent Neural Networks. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. html

Zhu P*, **Yang Q***, et al. (2023). Working-Memory-Guided Attention Competes with Exogenous Attention but Not with Endogenous Attention. *Behavioral Sciences*, *13*(5), 426. doi:10.3390/bs13050426

Han H W*, Dhar R*, **Yang Q***, et al. (2024). Investigating the role of modality and training objective on representational alignment between transformers and the brain. *NeurIPS Unireps Workshop*. html

Conference Presentations & Abstracts

Yang Q*, Han H W*, Song B*, et al. (2026). Hierarchical representational transformations of working memory in brains and machines. *Spotlight poster (top 10%) at Conference on Computational Cognitive Neuroscience (CCN). Poster at Vision Sciences Society Annual Meeting (VSS).*

Han H W, **Yang Q**, Mohsenzadeh Y (2026). Concept Manifold Geometry Explains Asymmetry in Model–Brain Bidirectional Predictivity. *Talk and Spotlight poster (top 10%) presented at CCN.*

Yang Q, Li HH (2025). Reward Shapes Resource Allocation in Working Memory. *Poster presented at VSS Annual Meeting.* html

Goldway N, Harhen N, **Yang Q**, et al (2025). Correspondence between reinforcement learning phenotypes and transdiagnostic clinical symptomatology across development. *Poster presented at CCN as Extended abstracts.* html

Goldway N, ..., **Yang Q**, et al. (2023). Reliability of a reinforcement-learning task battery for computational phenotyping of decision-making in adolescent psychopathology. *Poster presented at Computational Psychiatry Conference (cpcof)*.

Yang Q, Curtis C (2022). Effects of Interrupting Parietal Cortex Neural Activity on Working Memory Prioritization. *Talk presented at Neuromatch Conference (NMC).*

Fellowships and Awards

Elsevier/Vision Research Travel Award**,** VSS	2026
Graduate Student Research Enhancement Awards (GSREA), OSU	2026
University Fellowship, OSU	2024

Professional Activities

Conference Reviewer

Conference on Computational Cognitive Neuroscience (CCN)	2026
NeurIPS Unireps workshop	2024-2025

Teaching Assistant

Sensation and Perception, OSU, undergrad	2026
Psychology of Creativity, OSU, undergrad	2025
Introduction to Psychology, OSU, undergrad	2025
Advanced Psychological Statistics, NYU, undergrad	2022